REID GILLIS

LinkedIn Portfolio reid@nananacademy.com

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Combines robust engineering capability with narrative design expertise and 10 years of Fortune 500 leadership experience—consistently refining design through iteration, unifying creative and technical disciplines, and fostering collaborative, high-performing teams.

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

Languages: C++, C#, Python, JavaScript, PowerShell, SugarCube, Ink
Applications: Unity 6, Unreal Engine 5, Unreal Engine 4, Visual Studio, Rider, Twine, Inkle
Tools: Git, Hack-n-Plan, Figma, Unreal Insights, Materials Shader, Perforce

EDUCATION

DIPLOMA, PROGRAMMING FOR GAMES WEB & MOBILE
Vancouver Film School | 2024 – 2025

DIPLOMA, WRITING FOR FILM, TV & GAMES
Vancouver Film School | 2022 – 2023

BACHELOR OF COMMERCE - MANAGEMENT
MacEwan University | 2009 – 2015

PROGRAMMING EXPERIENCE

NANAN ACADEMY | GAME DEVELOPMENT INSTRUCTOR AND COURSE DESIGNER
Oct 2025 - Present

- Designed a **160-hour C++ course** for complete beginners, covering memory management, pointers, OOP, compile-time and runtime polymorphism, templates, smart pointers, function pointers, and event systems.
- Designing an **Unreal Engine 5 gameplay programming course in both C++ and Blueprints**, guiding students through a 2.5D third-person platformer that covers core gameplay classes, components, interfaces, delegates, Unreal macros, Gameplay Tags, modules and plugins, UI, and the Unreal build pipeline.

FROGS AND FREEDOM | GAMEPLAY PROGRAMMER & TECHNICAL NARRTIVE DESIGNER (UNREAL ENGINE 5)
Jan 2025 – Aug 2025

- Wrote **tutorial scripts and one-liners,** for GRANT BOOM (40s) an aggressively macho and over-the-top right-wing character. The dialogue guided player during onboarding and reinforced the game's satirical voice.
- Built a **scalable GameplayTag-driven architecture** supporting enemy types, **dialogue queuing**, **EQS queries**, and encounter wave logic, enabling flexible and iterative encounter setups.
- Designed and implemented **modular enemy waves and token-based attack systems**, allowing dynamic spawn logic, triggers, and difficulty that support emergent gameplay and varied encounter pacing.
- Designed and developed **AI traversal and decision-making systems** using behavior trees, custom EQS pathing tests, and **AIPerception/TeamAttitude** filtering, encouraging the player to stay in motion while maintaining clear enemy fronts and readable threat patterns.
- Created a **hierarchical objective system** using SOLID principles, balancing flexible mission and sub-objective design with technical consistency.
- Implemented an **event bus** using the mediator pattern, reducing coupling, simplifying communication, and improving runtime performance.
- Developed **custom toon and weapon shaders** using multiple rendering techniques to enhance enemy attacks and match the game's stylized art direction.

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WITCH'S WAND | GAMEPLAY PROGRAMMER & TECHNICAL NARRTIVE DESIGNER (UNITY 6)
Nov 2024 – Jan 2025

- Co-authored script for eight comic panel cutscenes, crafting a concise, impactful story about a young girl facing her fear with the theme "to get over your fear, you have to face it."
- I Implemented the narrative system to trigger cutscenes, in-game dialogue, and track story progression.
- Built systems for handling input, encounters, inventory, abilities, combat and player state.

PURRFECT MATCH | PROGRAMMER & TECHNICAL NARRTIVE DESIGNER (UNREAL ENGINE 5)
Oct 2025

- Authored three-page script about, MIKI (13), proving to her parents that Pixel, the unfriendly foster cat Miki has fallen in love with, can fit in with the family and that Miki can care for her.
- Built narrative system using an array of data-assets.
- Implemented efficient match-detection using a sliding-window algorithm to scan grid data for vertical and horizontal adjacency patterns, enabling fast removal and scoring logic even at larger grid sizes.
- Rapidly prototyped core gameplay loop—including swapping mechanics, gravity resolution, and chain reactions—allowing rapid iteration on game feel and progression pacing.

BUSINESS EXPERIENCE

BUCKHEAD MEATS | MANAGER
Jun 2023 – Aug 2024

- Developed an internal inventory organization tool and implemented process improvements contributing to the company's most profitable year in over a decade.
- Improved inventory accuracy and reduced operational bottlenecks through efficiency initiatives.

COCA-COLA BOTTLING LIMITED | WAREHOUSE SUPERVISOR
Feb 2021 – Jan 2022

- Directed a team of 37 employees to process hundreds of daily orders with accuracy and speed.
- Built an automation tool that standardized processes, reduced labor hours and improved consistency.

CINTAS | PRODUCTION SUPERVISOR & SIX SIGMA BLUE BELT
Nov 2017– April 2020

- Directed a team of 56 employees processing 8,000+ uniforms daily, ensuring efficiency, quality, and safety.
- Developed an automation tool that corrected critical database errors during an AS400-to-SAP transition, eliminating costly manual work and reducing error rates.

CINTAS | MANAGEMENT TRAINEE
Feb 2014 - Nov 2017